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Krishna Janmashtami - 2024

The Crossroads



EVER
ROOTED
IN THE
TRUTH

The Editorial

BHARAT - MY LIFE, MY
PRIDE

Sanvi Sah

TIME - YOUR MOST
VALUABLE RESOURCE

Kavin Rajesh - IB 1st year

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**Trailblazing with TOK:
The Quest for Truth**

Neeraj Suresh | IB I Year, CIRS

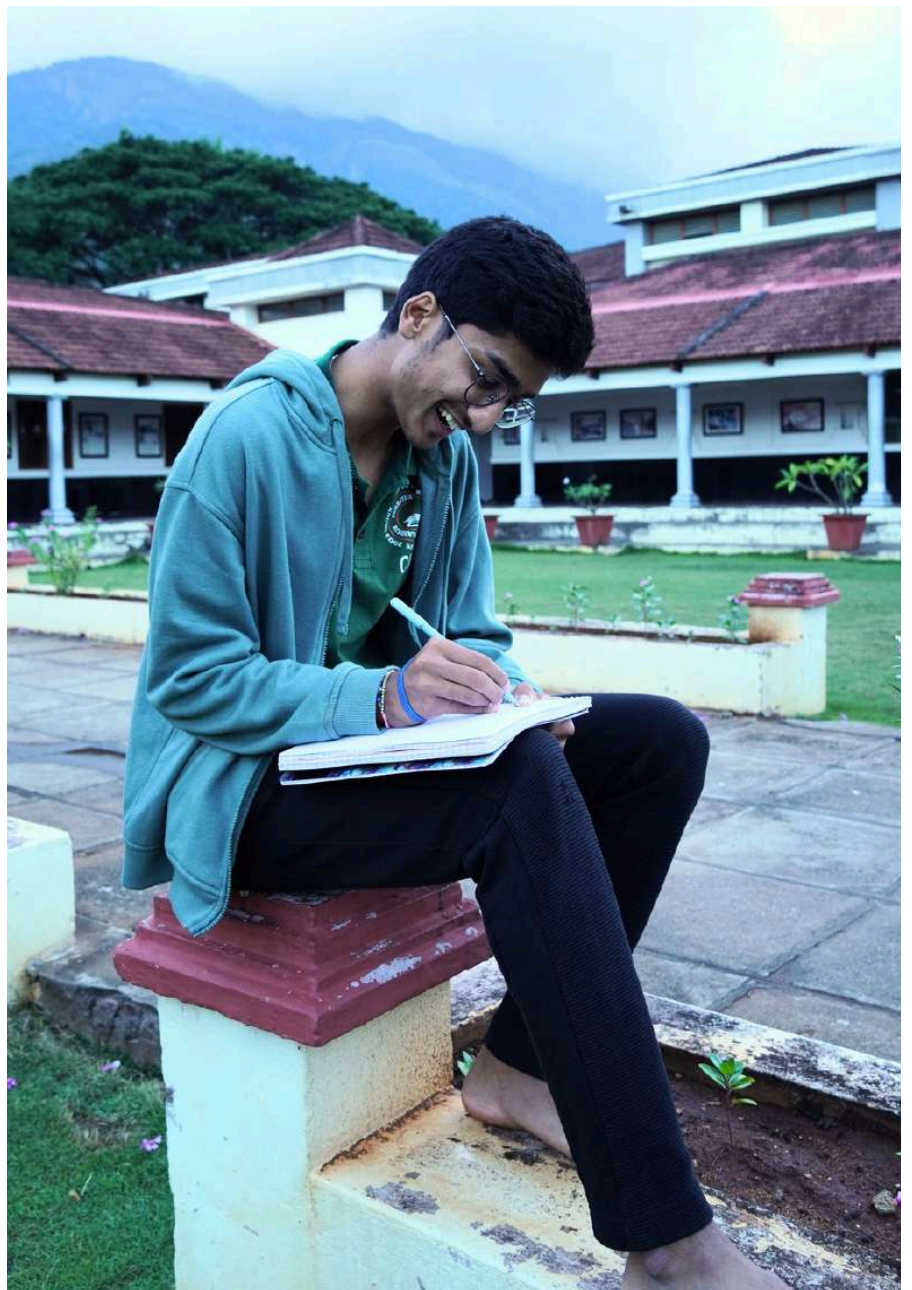


EVER ROOTED IN THE TRUTH

"A tree without its roots would fly away with the wind, a skyscraper lacking foundation is hopeless in the tempest; likewise, the one who fails to enroot himself in truth amid his life, will wither and succumb to life's strenuous tests."

The concept of Truth is the crux of spirituality, the fundamental undertone of dharma, and the beacon of knowledge that guides the earnest seeker forward. However, this sometimes fragile concept of Truth is often compromised upon for the sake of achieving fleeting highs. The commonly held belief presumes that practicing truth in everyday life is impossible; and hence, we usually overlook those small, seemingly insignificant lies that we speak on a daily basis. Practicing truth is like a rocky mountain hike, inconvenient and filled with perils and pitfalls. But the magnificent view from the peak is completely worth all the hard work. Lies are like quicksand- extremely easy to fall into, and nearly impossible to come out of. After reaching the summit of truth, only peace and fulfillment remain as our constant companions.

Lying on the other hand forms the core of escapism: the tendency to abscond from an uncomfortable situation. Lying appears to us as a welcoming and easy evasion from the problems of life, luring the unsuspecting and carefree mind onto it. A fake sense of assertiveness gradually develops; and every successive falsehood makes it easier to justify the deceit that we spin on a daily basis. Slowly -and almost invisibly- the degradation of our character and personality takes place and lying becomes second nature.



Moreover, truth is not limited solely to right speech; it also reflects in man's attitude, just as integrity reflects in his actions. When a person stands rooted in his mindset of truth in the face of external influence, the greatest respect for him arises. Truthfulness also calls for unbiased decisions taken by a discriminating intellect precise and uncompromising in its approach. There must be no inclination towards other choices; only the right one must be identified and upheld. Truth also encompasses becoming reliable, dependable and accountable for responsibilities undertaken, and to hold fast unto the promises and commitments made.



Today, even global information is tainted by biases that distort the truth for the sake of attention. Newsmongers publish “views” that serve their own purposes under the guise of authentic “news” to the public. Since the common man does not verify the original source of the news, his opinions and worldview is corrupted by the falsehood fed to him. With international headlines being twisted to attract eyes, avarice in the minds of media houses is ruining the reality for the sake of business and profit. Hence, our motto of “Nityam Satye Pratishtitam” - Ever Rooted in the Truth- was chosen for the Crossroads. This is our pledge to never compromise on the credibility of our articles and content. It is the fundamental principle that we abide by, so that our readers always experience authentic, dependable and truthful journalism right here at CIRS.

CURATED QUIPS

The Pran Pratishtha ceremony for the 90-foot-tall Hanuman statue, known as the "Statue of Union," took place on August 18 in Houston, Texas. Situated at the Sri Ashtalakshmi Temple in Sugar Land, Texas, it is now the third tallest statue in the United States. The statue honors Lord Hanuman's role in reuniting Sri Rama and Sita, drawing global attention to its significance.

The Crossroads Editorial

HAPPY RAKSHA BANDHAN

Celebrating Siblinghood - *Compiled by the School Social Media Team*



“COLONIAL INTERPRETATIONS OF OUR FESTIVALS ARE PATRIARCHAL, DHARMA IS NOT”

BE DHARMIC! BE UNAPOLOGETIC! CELEBRATE WITH PRIDE!

Time: Your most valuable Resource

KAVIN RAJESH | IB I YEAR, CIRS

Imagine you have a bank account with 86,400 rupees in it. Every day, the bank account is refreshed with the same amount of money, but there is a catch. Whatever you do not spend by the end of the day disappears. No savings, no rollovers. So, what would you do? You would probably spend it to the last rupee and ensure none goes to waste. Now replace these rupees with seconds. Every day you are given 86,400 seconds to utilize, but just like the money, once gone, it is gone for good. There is not even the slightest possibility of getting it back. Such is the fleeting nature of time. Time is limited. You can always earn more money but never reclaim lost time. How your time is spent determines the course of your life. Recognising this is the first step to achieving a fulfilling and purposeful life

Despite knowing the value of time, many fall prey to snares that lead to wasted hours, days, and even years. These traps can be subtle, often disguised as harmless habits or necessary actions. One such trap is procrastination. All of us have done it at least once. What starts as a small delay, quickly spirals into a cycle of stress and anxiety. The more you postpone, the more daunting the task becomes, eventually leading to a frantic, last minute-rush that rarely produces the best work. And then there is the digital jungle in which we all get lost once we go in deep enough. Social media, streaming services and endless notifications inundate you with distractions, slowly eating away at your day. And before you realize it, hours have vanished, leaving you in the dark.

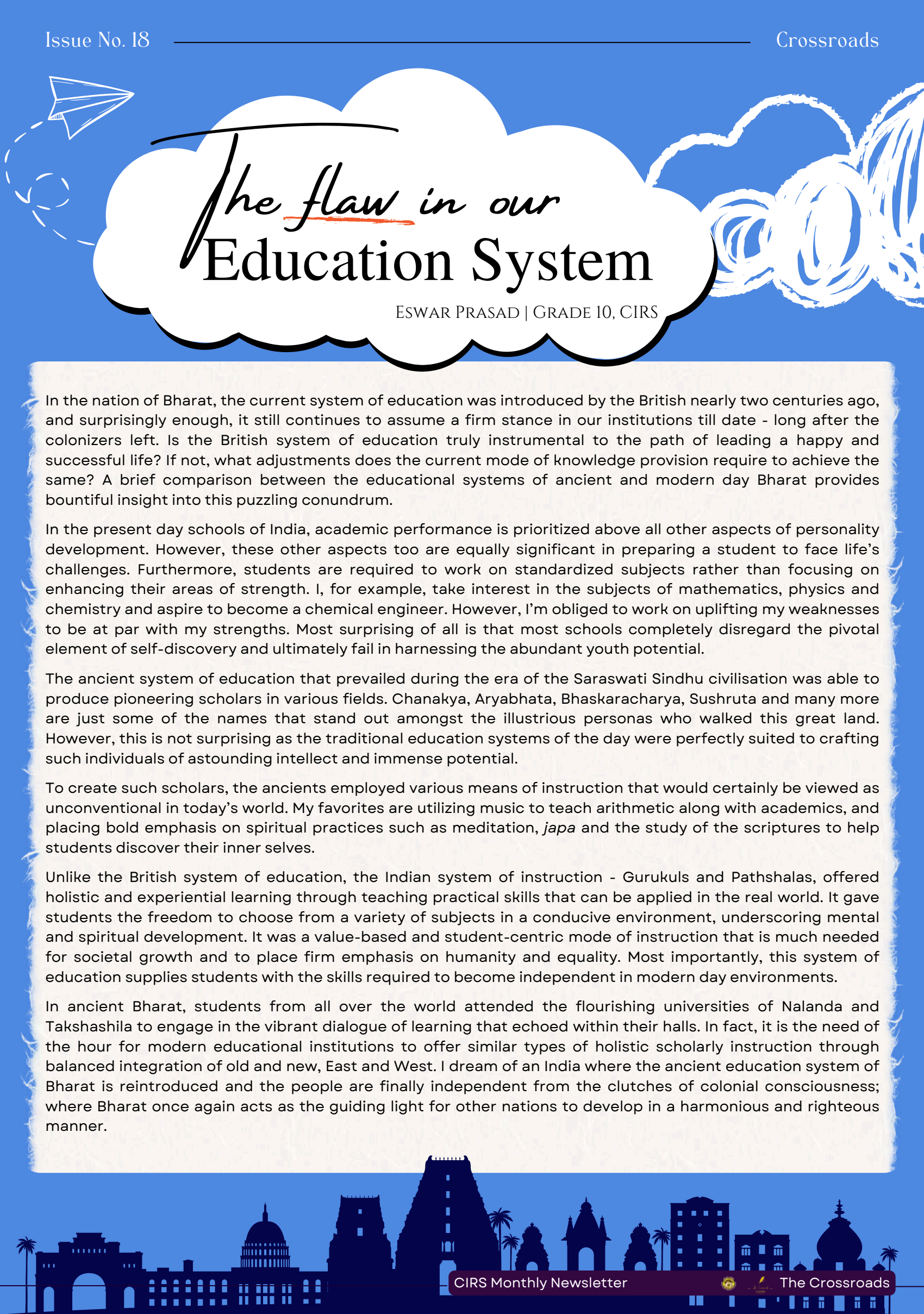


Finally, not many realize how multi-tasking allures you with the promise of efficiently managing your time, but this so-called efficiency can be deceiving. It might seem like a superpower, but it is often more like juggling flaming torches - exciting, but risky. Torn between tasks, your brain simply slows down. Instead of mastering one thing, you end up spreading your focus too thin, wasting time in the process.

Now that we have learnt the different traps of time, let's shift gears and look for ways to reclaim this lost time. This isn't just about managing our time, but living our life with a new meaning and intent. To begin with, discipline is key. To sail through the sea of distractions, you must have a clear goal that will serve as a compass, pointing you in the right direction. Whether it is finishing a project or building a career, having a clear target keeps you on course. Next, always remember that your free time is gold, so treat it that way. Don't feel guilty about taking a breather or relinquishing a hobby. These moments of peace are paramount for recharging and preventing exhaustion. And finally, amid the hustle, don't forget to pause and enjoy the present. Life isn't all about future goals, it is happening right now. Whether you are sharing a laugh with loved ones, having a long-deserved vacation, or savoring a quiet moment, being fully present adds richness and joy to life.

Time is the most valuable currency you will ever have, and how you invest it shapes the story of your life. By recognising and avoiding the common snares, you can reclaim the lost days with purpose. Focus on what truly matters, whether you are chasing a dream, cultivating a passion or simply enjoying life's simple pleasures. Each moment is a blessing, spend it wisely and you will compose a life brimming with meaning, joy and pride.





The flaw in our Education System

ESWAR PRASAD | GRADE 10, CIRS

In the nation of Bharat, the current system of education was introduced by the British nearly two centuries ago, and surprisingly enough, it still continues to assume a firm stance in our institutions till date - long after the colonizers left. Is the British system of education truly instrumental to the path of leading a happy and successful life? If not, what adjustments does the current mode of knowledge provision require to achieve the same? A brief comparison between the educational systems of ancient and modern day Bharat provides bountiful insight into this puzzling conundrum.

In the present day schools of India, academic performance is prioritized above all other aspects of personality development. However, these other aspects too are equally significant in preparing a student to face life's challenges. Furthermore, students are required to work on standardized subjects rather than focusing on enhancing their areas of strength. I, for example, take interest in the subjects of mathematics, physics and chemistry and aspire to become a chemical engineer. However, I'm obliged to work on uplifting my weaknesses to be at par with my strengths. Most surprising of all is that most schools completely disregard the pivotal element of self-discovery and ultimately fail in harnessing the abundant youth potential.

The ancient system of education that prevailed during the era of the Saraswati Sindhu civilisation was able to produce pioneering scholars in various fields. Chanakya, Aryabhata, Bhaskaracharya, Sushruta and many more are just some of the names that stand out amongst the illustrious personas who walked this great land. However, this is not surprising as the traditional education systems of the day were perfectly suited to crafting such individuals of astounding intellect and immense potential.

To create such scholars, the ancients employed various means of instruction that would certainly be viewed as unconventional in today's world. My favorites are utilizing music to teach arithmetic along with academics, and placing bold emphasis on spiritual practices such as meditation, *japa* and the study of the scriptures to help students discover their inner selves.

Unlike the British system of education, the Indian system of instruction - Gurukuls and Pathshalas, offered holistic and experiential learning through teaching practical skills that can be applied in the real world. It gave students the freedom to choose from a variety of subjects in a conducive environment, underscoring mental and spiritual development. It was a value-based and student-centric mode of instruction that is much needed for societal growth and to place firm emphasis on humanity and equality. Most importantly, this system of education supplies students with the skills required to become independent in modern day environments.

In ancient Bharat, students from all over the world attended the flourishing universities of Nalanda and Takshashila to engage in the vibrant dialogue of learning that echoed within their halls. In fact, it is the need of the hour for modern educational institutions to offer similar types of holistic scholarly instruction through balanced integration of old and new, East and West. I dream of an India where the ancient education system of Bharat is reintroduced and the people are finally independent from the clutches of colonial consciousness; where Bharat once again acts as the guiding light for other nations to develop in a harmonious and righteous manner.

BHARAT – MY LIFE, MY PRIDE

SANVI SAH | GRADE 10, CIRS

Freedom, Liberty, Equality, Respect, and Unity are some of the words which resonate across the length and breadth, from dusk to dawn across this very subcontinent. Bharat has been a beacon of hope and inspiration for billions across the globe. This country may be diverse in a million different ways, but what is it that makes Bharat unique? What is it that sets us, the Bharatiyas, apart from others? What is that philosophical contribution that makes us different?

Well, a defining aspect that has truly shaped the world view of every Bharatiya since time immemorial is the underlying philosophy of living that guides every action- Dharma. To understand this ancient concept, one must understand the core principle of its teachings. The most common translation of Dharma is religion, but the term has 6 different connotations according to the Dharma tattva- Morality, Virtue, Neeti (law), Guna (Nature), customs and traditions, and religion. Thus, Dharma is a holistic approach to life for all individuals; keeping us rooted in our culture, and binding us together as one civilization.

“One fire burns in many ways, one sun illuminates the world, one dawn dispels the darkness of night, that exists in one and has taken various forms.”

-Rig Veda

This verse encapsulates one of the greatest contributions that India has given to the world- The vision of Universal Oneness. Bharatiyas have never judged anyone despite any and every cultural and religious difference; our very nature has always been considerate and respectful to all. But alas! It was this very consideration that allowed the British to gain footholds into our nation. First under the innocuous guise of trade followed by the mad rush for power and control. But never, not even after decades of cruel oppression did we relinquish our faith in Universal Oneness.

सर्वे सुखिनः भवन्तु - May all be happy.”

This prayer resonates beyond the boundaries of Bharat, a long standing testament to our inclusive nature. To protect and propagate this vision of cosmic unity and all-encompassing vision is the fundamental duty of every Bharatiya. Long has it been known that Bharat is one of most diverse cultures. By praying for the happiness of all people Bharat reinforces the interconnectedness of every individual; calling forth a collective aspiration which helps bridge a multitude of differences. Over the centuries, it wasn't the bloody foreign invasions or the meteoric rise of monarchs that we remembered; rather it is the concepts of philosophy and commitment to discovering the inner self that have endured in our country.

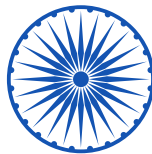
Since the Vedic period, Bharat has had a legacy of harmonious development in art, science, architecture, literature and religion. In recent years, Bharat's progress has been marked by rapid economic growth, technological advancements and increasing global influence. Scientific innovation in the field of information technology and telecommunications, has propelled Bharat to become a global leader and producer. This resurgence has also led to a renewed sense of national identity and pride, once again reinforcing Bharat's role as a significant player on the world stage. Bharat's notable successes in various fields adds to her growing prominence and sustainability.

It isn't just about the various advancements and developments in the country, but also about how it has evolved as a nation. It has never failed to strike awe within the people of the world, being ever supportive and open to helping anyone and everyone. Bharat has been actively supporting other countries through various means including economic aid, development, assistance and humanitarian efforts.

Complimenting Bharat's growth as a global powerhouse, is her military and strategic prowess. The Kargil war of 1999 highlighted India's military resilience and strategic brilliance. The recapture of the high mountain passes of Kargil showcases the bravery of the Indian forces, bolstering national pride and fanning the flames of patriotism.

Throughout history numerous alien invaders have attempted to impose their dominion over this land, yet have always failed to conquer and sway the minds of the people. Despite all persecution nothing was capable of touching our spiritual integrity and belief in our culture. This is due to the strength of a mind without fear, created by knowledge that spread freely across this vast land strengthening the will of the masses.

Time and again we have proved that Bharat will rise up once again to defend her identity and prove to the world her capabilities. The people of this nation stand rooted in the tenets of their ancient philosophy, leading the world towards a brighter future.



NEETI NIRMAN

INTER-HOUSE POLICY MAKING COMPETITION
Shrikanth Jindal | 11 MGMT, CIRS



The Niti Nirman competition was filled with participants brainstorming new policies aimed to improve the current situation of the people as well as the government. The catch though was the budget planning, which meant that every House had to provide justification for the money expended for their policy. The technicalities that we had to navigate throughout the contest were truly challenging but were just as much entertaining. Our knowledge, problem solving skills and diplomacy were stretched to their limits as we literally ideated and innovated on our feet. Moreover, the strict time constraints applied really kept all of us working diligently. Finally all Houses presented their excellent policies before the judges. Kudos to the YEI team for such an innovative and engaging conference.

AN INDIAN IN INDONESIA

VISHV PREM | GRADE 9, CIRS



Indonesia is a beautiful country located in the warm waters of southeast Asia. Officially called the Republic of Indonesia, it consists of over 17,000 islands including Sumatra, Java, Sulawesi and parts of Borneo and New Guinea. Intriguingly, this island nation has had a history of interaction with India since ancient times.

During the reign of the Chola dynasty, valiant kings like Raja Raja Chola expanded southward, spreading their influence throughout the group of islands we today call Indonesia. Here, we find various artifacts, manuscripts, and even epics such as the Ramayana till today, constantly reminding us that our ancient culture is not only limited to this subcontinent alone. The island of Bali in particular, receives hundreds and thousands of tourists from across the globe every year. One can find lovely, intricately crafted statues of gods such as Shivji, Ganeshji, Shri Ram and even the Pandavas. Aside from Bali's well known serenity, white sand beaches, delicious local food and beautiful architecture, the most fascinating thing about it is its people and the culture they follow.

Back home in a rapidly westernizing India, religion is considered rigid and frowned upon, with people across the country adopting fake identities to achieve superficial goals. In Bali, however, the locals pray a minimum of three times a day, and this includes taxi drivers, salesmen, fishermen and others not commonly associated with religion. Outside every Hindu home, there is a small temple made of volcanic black rock. The spectacular shows of the Ramayana at the Uluwatu Temple also pay homage to this glorious heritage. What is most worthy of mention is that these people portray their true selves to the outside world. If they are Hindu, they are proud to be one! They are absolutely rooted in their culture. We can lie to others by displaying false appearances, but not to ourselves. That honesty to the self is rare across the globe, but found at Bali island in Indonesia.





THE VALUE OF TRUST

KHUVI SARAWGI | GRADE 8, CIRS

I now understood that I had no choice except to put myself out there and talk to people.

Simple things like speaking in class presentations and participating in so many cultural programs really helped me.

Mingling made it easier for me to express myself; but not having the constant burden of carrying all my problems alone was the best part.

Being introverted is not a bad thing, but being able to express yourself freely without hesitation is better. Don't be afraid to go and talk to people. The worst that can happen is that they may not like you, and well, that doesn't really matter anyway. At the end of the day, your fears are the only thing that can hold you back. When you break free of these inhibitions, the sky is really the limit for your talents to express themselves.

Ever since I can remember I have always been an introverted person. I was never open to the idea of speaking to strangers, and never thought I needed

anyone to listen to my problems or advise me. I believed I could get through them alone. Which is why coming to CIRS was quite a shocking experience for me, as I was far too reluctant to mingle with the many new people around me.

I remember holding myself together for an entire week in school, but I just broke down on Sunday. It was 6:30 in the morning when I went to my sister's dorm and poured out all the suppressed feelings that were waiting to come out. That day I realized that everyone needs a trustworthy person in their lives who will listen to their problems and guide them.

Only after my sister left, it struck me once again that I needed someone else to open up to and socialize with.

Before long, I found that I just could not pass a single day in school without talking to a person whom I did not know. It was then that it dawned on me just how much I was missing out on. Only because of the fact that people did not know me, I could not expect any opportunities to come my way.

This amazing place got me out of the shell that I had built for myself over time. Until I did not break free of my comfort zone, I knew I would be stuck at the same level, unable to achieve anything beyond the average. I realized that I was limiting myself, when I had the potential to be so much more.



THE QUEST FOR TRUTH

Trailblazing with TOK

NEERAJ SURESH | IB I YEAR, CIRS

The concept of Truth is unequivocally necessary for the proper functioning of the world. Without truth, there would not have been any progress for humankind.

For instance, if we assume the general theory of relativity $E=mc^2$ to be an untrue statement; then the team of scientists at CERN would have been unable to create the Hadron Particle collider as that revolves around this theory of mass-energy equivalence. Similarly, there are many other inventions and discoveries that are credited to the mass-energy equivalence equation but would not exist today if not for the equation being considered a truth.

But how can we verify the truth? Well, some might say to just look around and see if the truth matches with what is happening around us. But how can we know for sure that what we see is the truth? This plunges us into an endless loop of verifying the verification. So where is the end of this mind boggling spiral? If there is no end, how can we ever verify something to be completely and undoubtedly true?

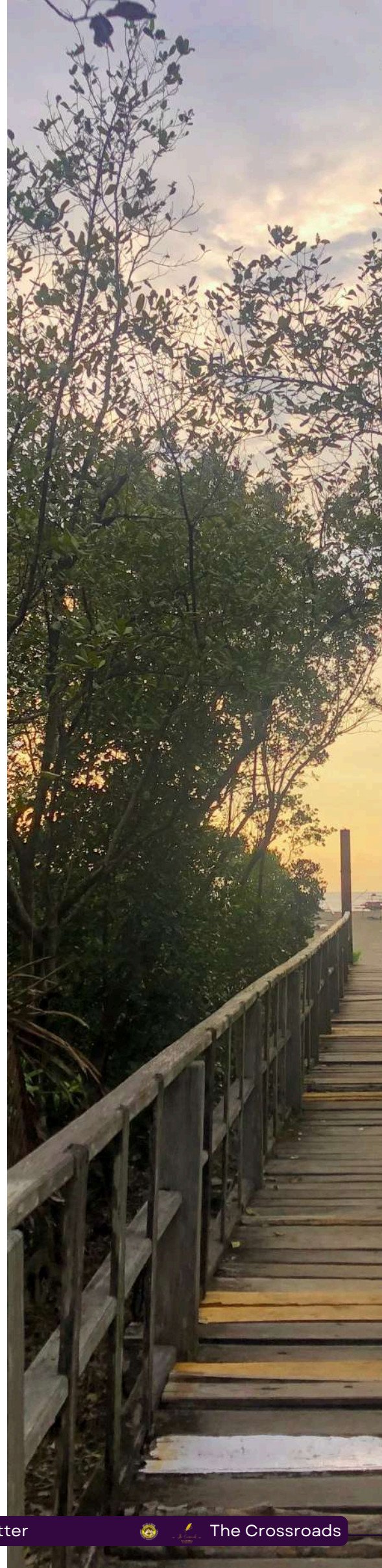
Over the course of history, many thinkers, philosophers and scientists have struggled with this problem, and have created their own sets of theories to ascertain the perfect truth.

The well known “Correspondence Theory of Truth” has no real origin to trace back to, but is said to be influenced by philosophers like Plato and Aristotle. It was introduced to the modern world by Bertrand Russell, and G.E Moore, two prestigious British philosophers.

The correspondence theory says that a belief is true if and, only if, it corresponds with something that exists in the real world. To put it simply, if the postulation aligns with reality, it can be considered to be the truth. For example, the claim ‘Mount Everest is the tallest mountain in the world,’ is true if this claim corresponds to Everest being the tallest as per an actual measurement of its height. If another mountain was found to be taller, the previous statement would be rendered false.

The limitation of this theory is that man experiences reality subjectively; he never experiences the world as it is, but only based on how his mind perceives it.

Now let’s take a look at the “Coherence Theory of Truth.” This states that any belief is considered to be true if it aligns with a body of other statements that we accept to be true. In other words, we juxtapose our hypothesis upon a web of beliefs that we presume to be correct.





The coherence theory of truth can be used to help individuals form beliefs based on information. Individuals can assess the truth by examining how well it integrates itself into the already existing narrative. This can be used to spot inconsistencies and provide a more solid understanding of the hypothesis. But the coherence theory also contains its fair share of limitations. According to it, even contradictory beliefs can be considered true. This is due to its lack of clarity in ascertaining which set of beliefs must be considered correct. This theory accepts truth solely based on previous beliefs which may, or may not be correct to begin with.

The last theory analyzed here is the “Pragmatic Theory of Truth.” This was majorly developed by three American philosophers: Charles Pierce, John Dewey and William James. According to them, “True Ideas are those that we can assimilate, validate, corroborate, and verify. False ideas are those that we cannot.” In a nutshell, a belief is true if it proves to be useful or beneficial in real life applications. Thus the theory emphasizes on the practicality of the theory more than its relation with abstract reality.

In conclusion, there is no theory that can be claimed to be perfectly right or wrong. The use of each theory depends upon the situation and parameters taken into consideration. Therefore, a person must understand each theory properly and use them according to the environment they find themselves in.

**“BELIEVE THOSE
WHO ARE
SEEKING
THE TRUTH,
DOUBT
THOSE WHO
FIND IT”**

ANDRÉ GIDE



A SECOND CHANCE

TAVISH TIBREWAL | II MGMT, CIRS



First of all, I want you to think: If you were given a second chance at everything you've ever done in your life, would you take it?

Life always offers us multiple opportunities, but what matters most is whether we utilise these opportunities to their fullest. Second chances are like a blank canvas, offering us the freedom to paint a new picture of our future. Second chances are not just a fresh start; they also teach us that success is not final and failure is not fatal; both are just stages in the journey of life.

A second chance is all about that little extra effort and correcting our mistakes. Second chances are not always easy to spot, as they usually disguise themselves as setbacks. We often tend to lose these chances by remaining attached to our past failures, to a story without a happy ending and thus restricting our thoughts.

We're so obsessed with getting things right the first time, that we often give up on things - and sometimes ourselves - too easily when things don't work out. Most of the time, we don't even give ourselves a second chance.

We must learn how to spot these chances, which can be found through a change in perspective or a feeling of renewal. Second chances do not always mean that we are going to have exactly what we had before,

because there is something better waiting for us in the future. Every challenge is an opportunity to learn, grow, and evolve into the best versions of ourselves. Second chances are sometimes a miracle, it's not déjà-vu, rather, it's an opportunity that God has given us to change our lives. Reflection plays a crucial role in a thoughtful introspection of the decisions we had made earlier and the areas where we need to improve to make the second chance count. By learning from our own experiences, we gain the ability to make informed decisions in the future.

Second chances often require change. To various people, changes can mean different things; like stepping out of our comfort zone or being ready to face unfamiliar situations without thinking about what the result could be. By making these changes, we adapt ourselves to situations better, which can help us in overcoming crises with ease.

There is one force which determines how much change we bring in our second chance and that is determination. Determination means staying focused on our objectives and being committed to our goals. With determination, we can change the concept of a second chance into an achievable reality. Second chances are valuable but only when we turn these chances into successes. The ways in which we can do these are by setting clear goals and celebrating milestones; this will keep you motivated and will help you reach your goals faster.

However, many of us may wonder, "If there is always a second chance, then why should one worry in the first place?" But remember, God helps people who help themselves and are ready to rise above their failures. Not people who do not try at all and think that they will always get a second chance.

Micheal Jordan, a man who is known as the GOAT of basketball, has gone through lots of ups and downs in his life. In fact, he once said, "I have missed more than 9,000 shots in my career. I have lost almost 300 games. On 26 occasions I have been entrusted to take the game winning shot, and I missed. I have failed over and over and over again in my life. And that is why I succeed." Many of us give up after missing a shot in our life and don't try to work on our weaknesses. Instead we attempt to justify our mistakes by providing excuses for what made us fail. Instead, we must work hard and strive to turn our weaknesses into strengths.



It is natural that people change, thoughts change and the world changes, but if we confine ourselves to first chances only, we may miss out on many beautiful things in life. Life wants us to succeed, but the question is: do you want to succeed? Everyday, life will present us with a second chance that will challenge us in every possible way. That second chance could be the opportunity that changes your entire life, so seize it!



girl
up
महत्त्व

नारी है तू नारी है

PRANAV PANDEY | 12 MGMT, CIRS

नारी है तू नारी है,
तू जननी है, तू मेरी माँ है तू न्यारी है

तू शेरनी है तू न शिकार है,
सभ्यता को देती तू आकार है

आँखों में अगन है तेरे,
पलकों में कटार है

तू किसी पिता का मान है,
तू किसी मनुष्य की जान है

न तू अबला न तू शक्तिहीन,
तू निर्भर हो किसी पे तू न कोई दीन

तू तो स्वयं ही शक्ति है,
दिखा दे तू क्या-क्या कर सकती है

नारी है तू नारी है,
तू जननी है, तू मेरी माँ है तू न्यारी है

बना अपनी पहचान तू,
बन जा देश का अभिमान तू

तू जननी है तू मृत्यु है,
तू गंगा है तू शेरनी है

कभी तू बहन है तू कभी है बेटी,
कभी है माता तू कभी अर्धांगिनी है

साहस तलवार की तू नोक है,
क्रोध से तेरे भयभीत त्रिलोक है

नारी है तू नारी है,
तू जननी है, तू मेरी माँ है तू न्यारी है





CHINMAYAN INVESTORS

YOUTH ECONOMICS INITIATIVE

THE EDITORIAL TEAM



Imagine a nice neighborhood on the banks of the Hudson river near the southwestern tip of Manhattan, in a building that could house anything from a library to a McDonalds.

Well, the truth is far from this. That hallowed place is the World Trade Centre, Wall Street. It's the place responsible for several millionaires and even more bankruptcies. It's the place where a company's shares are bought and sold. The culmination of these purchases decides the fate of every company in the market. Ultimately, it all boils down to stocks. But what are stocks? How do their prices rise and fall? How does one invest in the stock market?

Thankfully, all these questions and many more were clarified in the session for ninth and tenth graders conducted by the Youth Economic Initiative (YEI) club right here at CIRS. The discussion was extremely insightful as it armed us with the rudimentary skills required to voyage through the hectic world of the stock market. We learnt about assets, liabilities and how to buy and manage stocks. Terms that previously meant nothing to us like 'Sensex' and 'Nifty50' are now comfortable spheres of discussion. We had Yashwardhan Kejriwal teach us the true meaning of being a bull in the market, and received a dose of inspiration from Samarth Poddar who made 6 lakhs in less than 3 months! Overall, it was an eye opening experience and we can say with utmost confidence that we are now ready to take the plunge into this fascinating field.

7 WAYS TO KNOW THAT YOU ARE A *Chefk*

WHEN YOU LIVE BY NATION ABOVE SELF.
WHEN YOU REVEL IN TRAVEL TO AN UNKNOWN PLACE.
WHEN YOU KNOW THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN GOAL IN LIFE AND GOALS OF LIFE.
WHEN YOU EMPOWER OTHERS TO EMPOWER YOURSELF.
WHEN YOU DO YOUR STUDY AND SADHANA EVERYDAY WITHOUT FAIL.
WHEN YOU STRIVE TO AWAKEN INDIANS TO AWAKEN INDIA.

All India Chinmaya Yuvakendra
@chykIndia



Chefk REFLECTIONS

For us, CHYK started off as an inspiring journey of self-discovery and continues to be so to date. As CHYKsters, we went out to various places for seva, visited temples for sadhana, and of course, enjoyed our hour-long CHYK classes every Sunday, which always exceeded time due to our heated debates on the various teachings of Gurudev.

Throughout this year, we learned more than we had ever thought possible, and one of the biggest learnings from CHYK that will forever be etched upon our hearts is believing in what and who we are! Though we may not be transformed individuals just yet, these small changes surely have made a difference in the way we perceive and react to things. After all, small pieces are the ones that ultimately complete the puzzle.



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When I first heard of CHYK, I thought it would be a spiritual club where we only have discussions and activities. And I was correct, except, it was so much better and more transformational than I thought it would be. A year of being a proud CHYK has genuinely impacted me. Today, I am much more happy, calm, focused and view life from better perspectives than I did when I first joined.

-Rushil Motamarri

Every article we discussed related to my life in some way or the other. After the intense discussion upon the topic of Karma, everything that happened to me reminded me of our class. It made me introspect about myself and my actions. I realised that for everything, I had a choice. The choice I made would define my future.

-Tavishi Bagaria



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CHYK honestly turned out to be exactly how I thought it would be: sheer potential in a circle of transformation, threaded by one vision - YOUTH ALONE CAN! Now whenever I see the blue band encircling my hand I get reminded of what I stand for. This blue empowers me to be different and make a difference, to transform myself to transform India.

-Bhavika Bazaz

We are the torchbearers of the Chinmaya Yuva Kendra - the leaders of tomorrow. We reaffirm that no matter the odds, the youth always can and will. For that is the service we undertook, when we were inducted into this journey. It is this very service that we devote unto Pujya Gurudev, pledging to fulfill his vision of transforming the world through our efforts.

A SOUTH AFRICAN SOJOURN

YUG DIDWANIA | GRADE 7, CIRS

One day last April, when my father asked me if I wanted to go on a trip to South Africa. Of course, I jumped at the opportunity! The time to leave arrived after a lot of impatient waiting. Unfortunately, obtaining a visa proved to be an issue; but after some hassle and a bit of magic on my uncle's part, we got it. We were finally ready to leave!

My flight had a long layover at Mumbai, and after an extremely long wait we finally left for Nairobi. On the flight, it was early morning and I saw the sun rising over the equator. It was like the earth had been split into two perfect halves. We landed in Johannesburg in the afternoon, rented a car, and without wasting a moment left for Kruger. Finally after 2 exhausting days of travel, we reached our hotel by the evening.

The next day, we left for the famous African safari. We were aiming to spot the BIG 5 : Buffalo, Elephant, Leopard, Lion and the one and only Rhino. We weren't lucky enough to achieve this on the first day, but with our hopes high we went for the safari again the following day. Despite the freezing cold, we found all 5! It was a scary but strangely exciting spectacle, as we watched animals roam free in

the wild. The next day, we planned to return to Johannesburg, and visit the God's Window along the way. The God's Window is one of the most panoramic sights in the world. It was so beautiful, it took my breath away! We saw majestic mountains and beautiful valleys, with clouds hovering over it all. It was literally like going to God's home and looking through His window.

Waking up early, we went to the Tsitsikamma National Park. There we went dirt biking, racing through mud courses, and over the suspension bridge towards the Tsitsikamma falls. Finally we went ziplining, an experience that I will remember for the rest of my life! There were 8 lines, my favorite being the 120 meter drop above the waterfall next to huge boulders.

The morning brought us to the wine estates of Babylonstoren. There were huge farms and we could pick anything we wanted. We plucked guavas, huge oranges, and lemons. There was even a fountain with animal statues spraying water at people as they passed by! We left for Cape Town that very evening. The apartment we stayed in had a fantastic view of the bobbing yachts on the surface of the crystal clear water.



The next day, we traveled through the Cape Peninsula Route, which traversed the huge coastline of Africa. This was one of my best trips ever, and I will be sure to cherish it. After everything I had witnessed, I felt like I could be doing so much more in my normal, day to day life. I hope for another trip like this someday soon!



Jealousy : THE MIND'S ECHO

RISHI CHOTHAN | IB 1 YEAR, CIRS

How do I stop feeling jealous? Why do I feel jealous all the time? Is jealousy destroying me? I'm sure many of us have asked ourselves these questions. I'm sure they had us racking our brains, searching for an answer. I'm sure that some of us are still looking for that ever so elusive answer. So, join me as I uncover the enigma that is jealousy.

What is jealousy?

To understand why we feel jealous, we must comprehend the concept of jealousy. Oftentimes, jealousy and envy are used interchangeably. However, this is heavily misunderstood. You feel envious of someone because they have something you desire or don't have. Whereas, you feel jealous of someone because you are afraid that they are trying to take away what you already have. For example, your neighbor has just bought a new Mercedes. You've been wanting a Mercedes for a long time and thus you begin to envy him. On the contrary, say that you have just won a 100-meter race for your school and even set a school record. You call your school friends and they congratulate you, but one runner friend criticizes you for your timing. Later, he begins to show more hostility and bitterness toward you. This is him being jealous: a more serious form of envy. They both involve a feeling of desire for what another person has, but envy does not often involve resentment or indignation.

For such a complex emotion like jealousy, it is expected that you would have to go down a rabbit hole to find its root cause. However, it is quite the opposite. People feel jealous when they think that others are better than them. They feel as if they are missing something from their lives that the other person has. This feeling deteriorates into hatred and loathing. Essentially, jealousy arises from moments of inferiority and insecurity. It is often the result of low self-esteem and negative thinking. Which ultimately brings me to the next point.

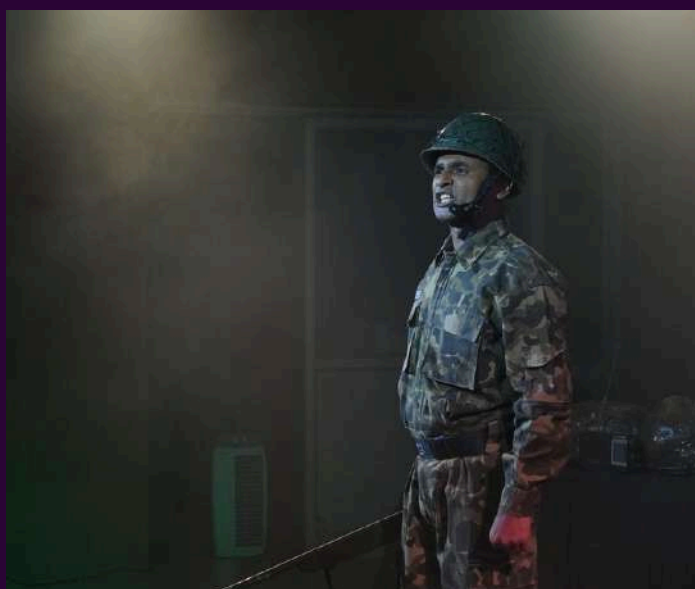
How do I overcome it?

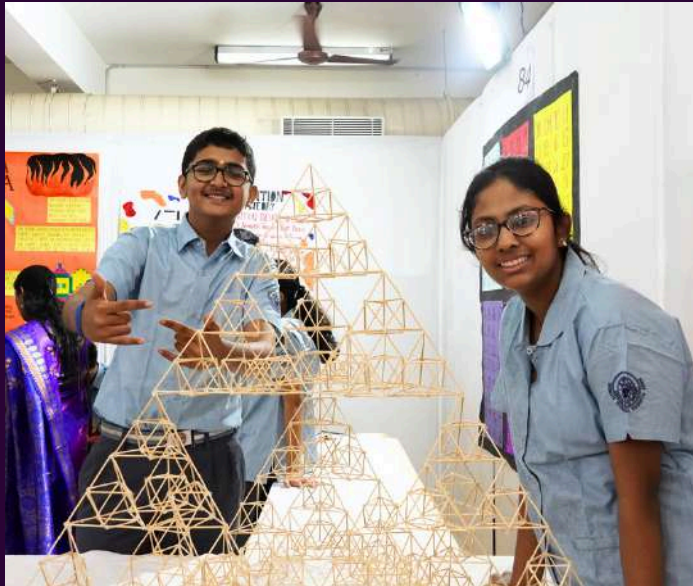
The first step you can take is to admit your feelings. If you think you feel jealous at a particular moment, you probably do. So, simply admit it. Sometimes, just identifying your emotions can set your mind straight. You could also talk to other people about it. If you don't feel comfortable talking to your family, talk to a best friend or a teacher. There is always going to be someone who cares about you. Furthermore, you should also stop comparing yourself with others. All it does is add salt to the festering wound of insecurity. Instead, focus on yourself and on your positive qualities.

Jealousy mainly branches out from moments of weakness so starting today, try and maintain a record of all the admirable traits you hold in a journal of some sort. Over the course of some days, write down all the good things you've done, or everything you love about your life. This way, whenever twinges of jealousy start creeping up on you, you can look back and read through it to get a burst of confidence. Ultimately, learning to love yourself is sufficient to defeat any kind of jealousy.



Captures







CREATIVE CORNER



M. K. Prateethi ~ XI 🎨



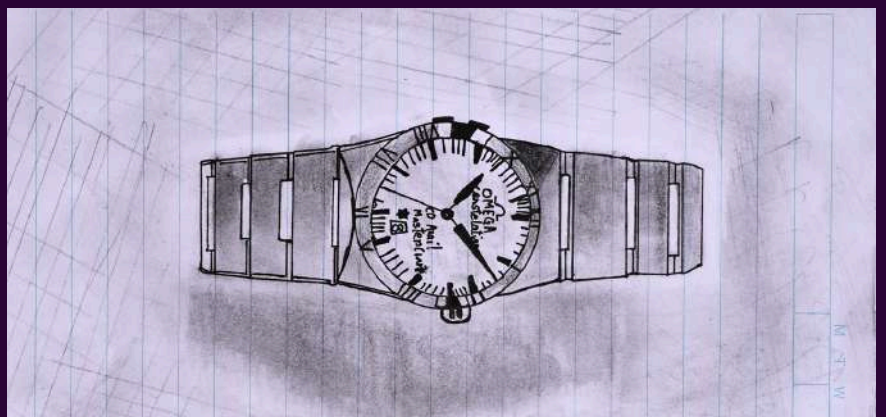
Gatik C. ~ XI 📷



S. S. Shailesh ~ XII 📷



Eklavya A. ~ VII 🎨



Rudransh T. ~ VI 🎨



Ritesh E. ~ X 🎨



Vaidehi M. ~ I IB 📷



Arth A. ~ VI 🎨



Pirai S. ~ VII 🎨



S. Rithesh ~ VII 🎨



Naitik A. ~ X 📷



Radha G. ~ X 📷

Growing youth, determined to reach their goal, sure of their dignity, consistent in their endeavors, proud of their culture - can alone bestow upon a growing country the status of a Nation.

August 2024 | Living the Vision of the Visionary

GODDESS DURGA RIDING TIGER



IN THE 1940S, THIS PAINTING WAS MADE BY FAMOUS POLISH ARTIST STEFAN NORBLIN AT UMAID BHAWAN PALACE, JODHPUR.

#INDIAPOLAND #BharatiyaHistoryPics

1943 :: LITTLE POLISH CHILDREN AT BALACHADI CAMP IN GUJARAT



MAHARAJA OF JAMNAGAR GAVE SHELTER TO POLISH CHILDREN WHO ESCAPED SOVIET SIBERIAN GULAG OF JOSEPH STALIN.

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